

Word family: ****recess / recesses / recessed / recessing / recessive****

****Base word:** recess**

****Plural:** recesses**

****Past tense:** recessed**

****Past participle:** recessed**

**** -ing form:** recessing**

****Related forms:** recessed, recessive**

****Part of speech:** noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)**

Your sentence:

> "...he quietly shared his notes with me during ****recess**** and helped me understand what I had missed."

Meaning in this passage

Here, ****recess**** means a ****short break during the school day when students stop lessons and can rest, eat, talk, or play****.

****繁體中文 : ** 學校上課期間安排的一段短暫休息時間 ; 小息 / 課間休息****

****中文翻譯 : ****

> "...he quietly shared his notes with me during ****recess****..."

「.....他在****小息 / 課間休息****時靜靜地把筆記給我看.....」

Here:

****during recess = 在學校課堂之間的小息時間****

1. ****recess = school break (學校) — 小息 ; 課間休息****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** A short period during the school day when lessons stop and students are allowed to rest or play.

Practice 1 — Original

> "He shared his notes with me during ****recess****."

「他在****小息****時把筆記給我看。」

Practice 2

> “The children went outside to play at **recess**.”

「孩子們在**小息 / 課間休息**時到外面玩。」

Practice 3

> “We usually ate our snacks during **recess**.”

「我們通常在**小息**時吃零食。」

recess = 學校一天的課堂之間，讓學生休息、玩耍或進食的一段短時間

This use is especially common in North American English.

British English more often uses:

> **break / break time**

2. **recess** = temporary break in formal proceedings (正式活動) — 休會；暫停

Recess can mean a temporary suspension of a meeting, hearing, court session, conference, or other formal proceedings.

Practice 4

> “The meeting went into **recess** for thirty minutes.”

「會議**休會 / 暫停**了三十分鐘。」

Practice 5

> “The judge called a short **recess**.”

「法官宣布**短暫休庭**。」

recess = 正式會議、聆訊、審訊或其他程序暫時停止，之後再繼續的一段時間

This shares the broad idea of:

> **activity temporarily stopping for a break**

with the school meaning.

For strict core counting, I would merge school recess and formal recess into one broader **temporary break** concept, while displaying both because the Chinese differs considerably.

3. **recess** = hollow/indented space (空間) — 凹位 ; 凹處 ; 壁龕

A **recess** can also be a part of a wall, room, or surface that is set further back than the surrounding area.

Practice 6

> “The shelves were built into a **recess** in the wall.”

「那些架子建在牆上的一個**凹位 / 壁龕**裡。」

Practice 7

> “A small desk fitted neatly into the **recess**.”

「一張小書桌剛好放進那個**凹入的位置**。」

recess = 比周圍表面向內凹入、形成一個較深空間的部分

This is genuinely different from a break in time.

4. **recess** = secluded or hidden part/place (深處) — 隱蔽處 ; 深處

Recess can also mean a remote, hidden, or deeply enclosed part of a place.

Practice 8

> “The animal disappeared into the dark **recesses** of the cave.”

「那隻動物消失在洞穴黑暗的**深處**。」

Practice 9

> “The documents were found in the hidden **recesses** of the cupboard.”

「那些文件在櫃子的隱蔽**深處**被找到。」

****recesses = 某個地方隱蔽、深入或不容易看見的部分****

This commonly appears in the plural:

> ****the recesses of...****

For database counting, I would merge this with Meaning 3 under the broader concept:

> ****an inward/deep part of a space****

5. ****the recesses of the mind/memory (比喻) — 心靈 / 記憶深處****

The spatial meaning can become figurative.

Practice 10

> “The memory remained somewhere in the ****recesses of his mind****.”

「那段記憶仍然藏在他****心靈深處****的某個地方。」

Practice 11

> “She searched the ****recesses of her memory**** for his name.”

「她在自己的****記憶深處****努力搜尋他的名字。」

****the recesses of the mind/memory = 心靈、思想或記憶中深藏、不容易立即接觸到的部分****

This is a figurative extension of the physical ****deep/hidden place**** meaning, not a new core sense.

6. ****recess = suspend proceedings temporarily (動詞) — 休會；暫停****

As a verb, ****recess**** means to suspend a formal activity temporarily.

Practice 12

> “The hearing was ****recessed**** until the afternoon.”

「聆訊****暫停 / 休庭****至下午。」

Practice 13

> “The meeting ****recessed**** for lunch.”

「會議為午膳而****暫停 / 休會****。」

****recess** = 暫時停止正式程序，稍後再繼續******

This is the verb corresponding to Meaning 2.

7. ****recess something into a surface (工程 / 設計) — 嵌入；使凹入****

As a verb, ****recess**** can also mean to set something back into a wall, ceiling, or other surface.

Practice 14

> “The lights were ****recessed**** into the ceiling.”

「燈具被****嵌入****天花板內。」

Practice 15

> “The handle is ****recessed**** into the door.”

「把手****凹嵌在****門板裡。」

****recess something** = 把某物設置得比周圍表面更深入 / 嵌入表面之內******

This directly develops from the physical hollow-space meaning.

Related form: ****recessed****

****Recessed**** is especially common in architecture and design.

Practice 16

> “The room has ****recessed lighting****.”

「房間裝有****嵌入式照明****。」

Practice 17

> “The cabinet has ****recessed handles****.”

「這個櫃有**內嵌式把手**。」

****recessed** = 嵌入牆面、天花板或其他表面之內，而不是突出在外的**

Common:

- * recessed lighting
- * recessed shelf
- * recessed doorway
- * recessed handle

Related form: ****recessive****

****Recessive**** is historically related but now has a specialized independent meaning, especially in genetics.

Practice 18

> “The condition is caused by a ****recessive**** gene.”

「這種情況由****隱性基因****引起。」

Practice 19

> “The trait is ****recessive**** rather than dominant.”

「這個特徵是****隱性的****，不是顯性的。」

****recessive** = 在遺傳上只有在特定基因組合下才表現出來的；隱性的**

This is useful modern vocabulary, but I would treat ****recessive**** as a lexical family extension rather than another meaning of ****recess****.

The Golden Manual specifically says family forms should be surveyed broadly but accurately labelled rather than mechanically counted as meanings of the base word.

Important distinction: ****recess** vs ****break****

****break****

is the broad everyday word for a temporary pause.

- > lunch break
- > coffee break
- > school break

recess

is more restricted:

- * school break, especially North American English;
- * formal temporary suspension of proceedings.

So:

- > “Let’s take a break.”

is much more general than:

- > “Let’s take a recess.”

Important distinction: **recess vs lunch break**

recess

usually refers to a shorter school break between lessons.

lunch break

specifically refers to the longer period set aside for lunch.

They can both be breaks, but they are not necessarily the same part of the school day.

Important distinction: **recess vs holiday/vacation**

recess

is usually temporary and relatively short.

holiday / vacation

usually means a much longer period away from school or work.

So the **recess** in your passage is a short break during the same school day.

Important distinction: **recess vs alcove**

For the physical-space meaning:

recess

= any area set back or indented from the surrounding surface.

alcove

= a small recessed section of a room, often large enough for furniture or a person.

So an alcove is a particular type of recess, but not every recess is naturally called an alcove.

Important distinction: **recess vs cavity**

recess

emphasizes an inward indentation or set-back area.

cavity

emphasizes an empty hollow space or hole inside something.

> a recess in the wall

> a cavity inside the tooth

They overlap in some technical contexts but are not generally interchangeable.

Countability note

Recess behaves differently by meaning.

School/formal break

Often uncountable in expressions such as:

> “during recess”

> “at recess”

But it can also be countable:

> “The court took two short recesses.”

Physical hollow

Normally countable:

> “a recess in the wall”

> “several recesses”

This countability distinction is useful for natural learner usage.

Useful expression: **during recess / at recess — 小息時**

Practice 20

> “We played outside **during recess**.”

「我們在**小息時**到外面玩。」

Practice 21

> “I’ll speak to him **at recess**.”

「我會在**小息時**跟他談。」

Both are natural in the school sense.

Useful expression: **go into recess — 開始休會 / 暫停**

Practice 22

> “The hearing went into **recess** at noon.”

「聆訊在中午開始**休庭 / 暫停**。」

Practice 23

> “The meeting went into **recess** for twenty minutes.”

「會議**休會**二十分鐘。」

This belongs to the temporary-break sense.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **recess**
* **recesses**
* **recessed**
* **recessing**

Useful lexical relative:

* **recessive**

Useful constructions include:

* during recess
* at recess
* call a recess
* go into recess
* a recess in the wall
* recessed lighting
* the recesses of the mind

The family is relatively small, so the main learning value lies in the contrast between the **break-in-time** meaning and the **inward/deep-space** meaning.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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recess — school break	學校上課期間讓學生休息、玩耍或進食的一段短時間；小息 / 課間休息
recess — formal break	正式會議、聆訊、審訊等程序暫時停止、稍後再繼續的一段時間
recess — indented space	比周圍表面向內凹入、形成一個較深空間的部分
recesses — hidden/deep parts	某個地方隱蔽、深入或不容易看見的部分；與 inward-space 義相關
recess — verb, suspend	暫時停止正式程序，稍後再繼續
recess — verb, set inward	把某物嵌入牆面、天花板或其他表面，使其不突出
recessed	嵌入表面之內、向內凹進的

| ****recessive****

| 遺傳學中的「隱性的」；相關詞但應視為獨立專門詞彙

|

For your original sentence

> "...he quietly shared his notes with me during ****recess****..."

The exact meaning is:

****recess = 學校一天中課堂之間安排的短暫休息時間****

So:

> ****during recess****

= ****在小息 / 課間休息時****

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****recess****:

1. ****a temporary break, especially at school or during formal proceedings****
2. ****an inward, hollow, or deeply set-back space****
3. ****verb — temporarily suspend proceedings or set something back into a surface****

I would merge ****school recess + formal recess**** under #1 at the semantic level, merge ****hidden recesses / recesses of the mind**** into #2 as literal/figurative extensions, and keep ****recessed**** and ****recessive**** as family extensions rather than inflate the base-word count.